

Make a sound feel remembered

A practical landscape guide for the AU and VST3 audio effect. Six recipes start on page 6.



PATINA

Darker colour. Gentle drift. Digital wear. Space.

PATINA processes audio you already have: piano, synths, drums, voice or environmental recordings. Insert it after your instrument or on an audio track. It does not make notes or import samples.

Guide map

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Your first minute

1. Play a piano or synth loop through PATINA.
2. Select bank A and choose Subtle tape.
3. Keep FX POWER orange. If the button says RESUME FX, click it to release Restore.
4. Leave Evolve off. Raise Wear to taste and use Mix to blend the treatment.
5. Copy to B, try a stronger setting, then compare A and B.

Preset browsing

Use the arrows beside the preset menu to browse. They replace the selected bank, so SAVE first to keep your sound.

01 / Shape the ageing

Hover over controls for help. Drag a dial, double-click it to reset, or click its value box to type.



Wear

Sets the amount of age directly when Evolve is off; sets the target when Evolve is on. 20-45% for gentle colour.

Age Time

5-180 seconds to reach the Wear target with Evolve enabled. 45-90 s for a gradual transition.

Instability

Pitch drift, flutter and a little signal-following dust. 0-15% for tuned keys; increase for wobble.

Mix

Blends the ageing treatment; also scales the added lo-fi, delay and

Output

Gain from -24 to +12 dB. Added effects can increase the final

Character

Fresh, Remembered and Almost forgotten become progressively more

Status + Evolve

The status message beside the display explains Bypass, Restore, a

Display note

The central percentage is the actual smoothed wear. The moving

02 / Add space

Delay and reverb sit after the ageing and lo-fi stages. Orange LEDs mean enabled; Amount still sets the audible contribution.



Delay: rhythm or a soft echo

Time: 30-1200 ms with TEMPO SYNC off. Changing time glides the echo pitch.

Feedback: 0-75%. More feedback creates longer repeating trails.

Amount: added echo level. Start at 10-25%.

TEMPO SYNC disables the millisecond dial; choose the musical division instead.

Reverb: distance and atmosphere

Size moves from compact rooms towards spacious tails. Amount adds diffuse ambience. Start at 10-20% for keys or drums, 25-35% for pads. Click the Reverb LED to compare without changing its settings. Reduce Amount before Size when a part feels too distant.

Reading divisions

1/4 = a quarter note; 1/8 D = dotted eighth; 1/4 T = quarter-note triplet. At 120 BPM these are 500 ms, 375 ms and about 333 ms. The host tempo display identifies HOST or the 120 BPM FALLBACK.

For clean comparisons

Leave some space between notes. Turning up Delay and Reverb together can raise peaks; use Output to leave headroom. Repeatable clears tails on playback restarts or detected seeks.

03 / Add lo-fi texture

Click LO-FI beside the centre display. It replaces the main knob row; MAIN CONTROLS brings that row back.



Crush Mix

Blends in the crushed signal. At 0%, Bit Depth and Rate Reduction have no audible contribution. Try 15-30% first.

Bit Depth

4-16 bits. Lower values make quantisation rougher and more obvious, especially in quiet details. Start at 10-12 bits.

Rate Reduction

1-24x. Larger values hold samples longer and add coarse, aliasing textures. 1x leaves the sample rate unreduced. Try 2-4x.

Hiss

Noise follows the input level and fades after notes. It works

Lo-fi LED

Enables or disables the whole section while retaining its settings.

A musical balance

For a soft worn edge, keep Bit Depth around 10-12, use moderate

A useful comparison

Copy your main sound to B. Add lo-fi in B, then compare A and B

04 / Compare, save and recall

Factory presets and OPEN replace the selected bank. The other bank is retained; COPY intentionally overwrites its destination.



A/B without losing the starting sound

1. Select A and choose a factory preset.
2. Click COPY TO B, then select B.
3. Change B or load another preset into it.
4. Switch A/B while a steady phrase plays.

LEVEL MATCH attenuates the louder bank by up to 18 dB. Allow a few seconds to settle.

Save your own .patina preset

1. Select the bank you want to keep.
2. Click SAVE and use a name ending in .patina, such as Evening keys.patina.
3. Choose a folder; the initial location is Documents / PATINA Presets.
4. To recall, choose a bank and click OPEN.

SAVE * means edits since this editor opened or the last load/save in this bank.

Saved in a .patina file

One bank's sound controls, including Restore, Bypass and effect LEDs.

Saved in your DAW project

Both banks, bank selection and global Level Match, alongside the current parameters.

Not saved as sound history

Echo/reverb buffers and current age progress. Preset files also exclude DAW tempo and Level Match.

05 / Recipes for musical parts

Load the named preset first. Keep Evolve off, Restore released and FX POWER orange. Values below override the preset; other values stay as loaded.



Dusty piano

Start: Worn piano. Play a sparse piano or electric-piano phrase.

Wear 40%, Instability 8%, Mix 55%.

Delay: 280 ms, Feedback 25%, Amount 20%.

Reverb: Size 40%, Amount 18%.

Listen for: soft edges with a clear first strike. Reduce Mix if chords lose detail.

Floating pad

Start: Faded pads. Use a slowly changing sustained synth.

Wear 55%, Instability 12%, Mix 65%.

Delay: 650 ms, Feedback 45%, Amount 30%.

Reverb: Size 80%, Amount 35%.

Listen for: a moving halo around the chord. Use fewer notes if tails become crowded.

Worn drum room

Start: Aged drums. Use a simple drum loop with some space.

Wear 35%, Instability 0%, Mix 45%.

Delay: 90 ms, Feedback 12%, Amount 8%.

Reverb: Size 25%, Amount 12%.

Listen for: body and short reflections without detuned drums.

06 / Recipes for atmosphere

These are suggested starting settings, not measured guarantees. Use your source and ears to set the final Mix and Output.



Faded digital memory

Start: Sun-bleached reel. Try a gentle synth melody or a sampled chord.

Wear 35%, Instability 10%, Mix 50%.

LO-FI: Crush Mix 25%, Bit Depth 10, Rate Reduction 3x, Hiss 8%.

Keep the preset's ambience; reduce Delay Amount if it distracts.

Distant landscape

Start: Frozen postcard. Feed it rain, a room recording, wind or distant activity.

Wear 45%, Instability 4%, Mix 60%.

Delay: Sync on, Division 1/1, Feedback 35%, Amount 18%.

Reverb: Size 85%, Amount 30%.

Listen for: depth without losing the location.

A disappearing ending

Start: Last light. Use the closing phrase of a song or a held chord.

Wear 85%, Age Time 30 s, Instability 18%, Mix 65%.

Evolve ON; Repeatable ON. Click Restore, then RESUME FX at the start of the passage. Keep audio playing.

07 / Choose a factory starting point

Twenty effect presets, organised here by listening purpose. Preset names describe treatments; they do not contain samples or instruments.



Gentle colour / instruments

Subtle tape - light colour.
 Gentle warmth - softening with stable pitch.
 Worn piano - darker keys.
 Paper lantern - soft keys and gentle ambience.
 Velvet room - restrained wear and compact reverb.
 Aged drums - stronger colour, steady pitch.

Movement / texture

Sun-bleached reel - drift with mild digital wear.
 Unstable cassette - obvious drift.
 Rain on cassette - wobble, digital wear and dotted echoes.
 Cracked radio - dark, crushed voice/sample treatment.
 Dusty projector - strong movement, grain and hiss.
 Rusted drum room - short slap and a tight room.

Space / evolving passages

Faded pads - softened sustained texture.
 Distant room - heavily faded tone.
 Temple after dusk - long dotted echoes.
 Ghost waltz - triplet repeats.
 Half remembered - dark half-note trails.
 Frozen postcard - whole-note ambience.

Preset note

Most factory presets apply their treatment immediately with Evolve off. Slow decay and Last light deliberately change over time. For fair comparisons, use the same passage and let Level Match settle.

08 / If something does not sound right

Start with the incoming track, then check power, Restore, Mix and the individual effect amount.



No sound at all

Confirm the source track produces audio with PATINA bypassed. PATINA is an audio effect, so it needs an instrument or recording feeding it.

Sound is clean / wear stays at 0%

Turn FX POWER on. If RESUME FX is shown, click it. Raise Wear and Mix. With Evolve on, allow time for age to grow.

An orange LED makes no difference

An enabled effect still needs Amount above zero. For lo-fi, raise Crush Mix or Hiss. Main Mix and Restore also govern the result.

Delay Time will not move

TEMPO SYNC disables the millisecond control. Change the note

Too much wobble, grit or blur

Lower Instability for steadier pitch. Raise Bit Depth or reduce

Values change after loading a preset

DAW automation can override recalled settings. Pause the relevant

Tail disappears / sound restarts

Repeatable resets histories on playback starts or detected seeks.

Update fails or AU is missing

Close the DAW before updating. Rescan plug-ins after installation